



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Thales Academy Raleigh
School Website: <https://www.thalesacademy.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Thales Academy Raleigh NC 27616 exhibits a robust classical education profile that aligns strongly with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School. The campus materials consistently foreground truth, goodness, beauty, and virtue; emphasize formation over mere information; deploy Trivium-informed curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with a focus on the Great Books and the Western canon; employ a pedagogy that blends direct instruction in the early years with Socratic dialogue, seminars, and rhetorical training in the upper grades; present a visible faculty core and mentoring culture; and actively engage parents as partners in a joint educational project. Core phrases such as pursuing truth, beauty, and goodness; Moral Philosophy within a Judeo-Christian frame; a structured grammar-logic-rhetoric pathway; and a Western-canon-centered curriculum recur throughout the site content, newsletters, and program descriptions. The school frequently references the Great Books, Latin study, classical leadership, and a family- and community-oriented ethos, all of which map squarely onto classical expectations.

Overall, the school earns CLASSICAL across all six categories, with especially strong signals in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Curriculum, Pedagogy, and Community. The website materials consistently discuss transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty), formation of character and virtue, canonical Western learning (Great Books, Western canon), Trivium-based structure, Socratic pedagogy in upper grades, and active parental partnership. There is clear evidence of liturgical/communal sensibilities via Judeo-Christian framing and shared intellectual heritage, combined with a strong public-facing emphasis on classical identity and lifelong learning.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence: The site emphasizes a Judeo-Christian orientation, natural law, and moral philosophy as foundational to education, with explicit language about truth, beauty, and goodness as real and knowable. The Thales First Principles include Natural Order, Human Dignity, Moral Philosophy, and Intellectual Inheritance (Western canon). The school also references objective truth and the *imago Dei* in shaping the curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Strong presence of positive religious/metaphysical keywords (Judeo-Christian worldview, natural law, *Imago Dei*, moral philosophy, truth, goodness, beauty, Western canon). No clear negative indicators observed in public materials. This yields a predominantly positive signal for this category.

Why this rating: The materials foreground transcendental moral realism, theological framing, and liturgical/community-influenced aims (as seen in the Judeo-Christian worldview, natural law concepts, and emphasis on objective truth and beauty). This aligns with classical expectations for a religious/metaphysical foundation.

- Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence: The mission centers on forming virtue and wisdom, not merely job preparation; education is framed as formation and the cultivation of humanity; the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty is

repeatedly foregrounded.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Keywords like virtue, wisdom, formation, truth, goodness, beauty, and human flourishing appear prominently; no negative indicators observed in public materials.

Why this rating: There is a consistent emphasis on formation of character and access to transcendent truths rather than narrow utilitarian aims. This fits the classical aim of forming virtuous, wise and humanly excellent citizens.

- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence: Strong articulation of liberal arts through grammar, logic, and rhetoric; a history-forward curriculum anchored in the Western canon; explicit Great Books/primary-text emphasis; Latin study; and a commitment to cultivating wonder. The Three Phases of Classical Education (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) anchor the program; the Great Books and Western canon are central.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Multiple positive curricular keywords are present (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, Western canon, Latin, history taught chronologically, primary texts, wonder). No negative curricular indicators identified.

Why this rating: The site explicitly maps to the canonical liberal-arts curriculum, with concrete references to the Trivium and Great Books, and a historical/chronological pedagogy.

- Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL

Evidence: Pedagogical approach blends contemplative/restful aspects with rigor; lower school emphasizes singing/chanting to deepen memory; upper school employs Socratic discussion and seminars; rhetoric training and public speaking opportunities exist; the Trivium-inspired progression is clear.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include Socratic method, seminars, debates, rhetoric, public speaking, and contemplative elements; lower-division singing/chanting and memory-focused practices also appear. No explicit negative pedagogy signals observed.

Why this rating: The mix of contemplative elements, memory-based traditional practices in the early grades, and Socratic/seminar-based higher-grade pedagogy and rhetoric training align with classical teaching methods.

- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence: The school maintains a faculty directory and leadership structure; faculty are described as mentors and the living curriculum; a culture of collegiality and virtue is implied by public-facing statements and faculty pages. A Head of School is listed for the K-8/9-12 divisions, and multiple faculty profiles are visible.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include language around “model teachers and mentors,” “living curriculum,” “core of the school,” and visible faculty directories. No negative indicators observed.

Why this rating: The referents to faculty as models, mentors, living curriculum, and a cohesive faculty community align with classical expectations for a school’s human-centered core.

- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence: The institution positions itself as a community that partners with families; there are resources for parents (resource library), admissions visits, and explicit calls for parent involvement, with language about families joining the school community and co-educator partnership.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include “Partnership with Families,” “parent partnership/co-educators,” parental engagement, home-school connection, and family formation; presence of parent-facing resources and opportunities for visits signals a strong engagement with parents. No explicit negative indicators observed.

Why this rating: The materials emphasize family partnership, parental involvement, and an ethos of parents as co-educators, consistent with the classical model of a school-community partnership.

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

- The six categories collectively map to a CLASSICAL profile for Thales Academy Raleigh NC 27616. The public materials strongly emphasize truth, goodness, beauty; formation of virtue; a Trivium-based curriculum with Great Books and Latin; a pedagogy blending direct instruction with Socratic methods; a living-faculty model; and an explicit parent/community partnership.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable, as the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL across all six categories. No needle-moving changes are required based on the current evidence.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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